The Battle of Britain

Germany launched air attacks on Great Britain in the middle of 1940. Known as the Battle of Britain, Germany failed miserably since the British Royal Air Force were far stronger than the German forces.

With Poland, Norway, Denmark, Belgium, Holland, and France under Nazi control, Britain confronted the German surge alone. Germany's codename for the invasion of Britain was Operation Sea Lion, which Hitler unobtrusively announced on the 16th of July. He declared that the German Air Force Luftwaffe was to destroy the British Royal Air Force as a prelude to an all-out attack. The next day, Hitler issued Britain a peace offering, which he called his 'last appeal to reason.' He said: 'It can only end in the annihilation for one of us. Mr. Churchill thinks it will be Germany. I know it will be Britain.' Many in Parliament were tempted to accept the peace offering but Churchill refused.

Hitler's air assault and the Battle of Britain both began on the 13th of August, known as the ''Day of the Eagle.' On this day, 1,485 German airplanes assaulted Britain's seaside landing strips. During the following month, the RAF and the Luftwaffe battled over the fields of southeast England. A series of dogfights occurred where the normal lifespan of a British pilot was considered to be four to five weeks. Be that as it may, the RAF had the advantage of home ground: if a British pilot needed to be rescued, he could parachute onto British soil at almost any time. On the other hand, the German pilots who landed were captured and imprisoned upon landing. Furthermore, the British used radar, which was still a relatively new technology at the time. They had already learnt through the group at Bletchley Park in Buckinghamshire to unscramble Germany's Enigma codes. Bletchley Park knew about Operation Sea Lion well before a large number of Hitler's officers did.

On August 23rd, a Luftwaffe watch got lost while coming back from a fight over Britain and erroneously besieged Croydon on the edge of London. The RAF retaliated by bombarding Berlin on August 25. There was very limited damage done in the attack but Hitler became angry and issued the order to